



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

Dress Code Policy for Civilian Staff

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DRESS CODE POLICY for Civilian Staff



INTRODUCTION

The attention of all members are invited to the contents of The Dress Code Policy, which is intended to provide clear guidelines for all staff members who are expected to adhere to the guidelines as it is related to Civilian Staff only. The policy also offers guidance to the staff on maintaining a standard of dress and grooming in keeping with our corporate image.

With the exception of the agreed “Dress Down Day,” the usual dress code is applicable.

Only the last Friday of every month is considered Dress Down Day. On that day, employees are allowed to wear **black or dark blue jeans** or regular pants/skirt with a shirt blouse. If this shirt blouse is not worn, employees must adhere to the dress code for regular workdays.

The guidelines provided are by no means exhaustive, but as a professional organization, we expect that good judgement will prevail. We encourage members of staff to liaise with their immediate supervisors for any clarification that may be required from time to time.

DRESS DOWN DAYS

Every last Friday of each month has been designated officially as “Dress Down Days.” On that day employees have the option to wear a shirt blouse and black or dark blue jeans pants/skirt.

Dress down is not mandatory; however, if an employee chooses to dress down, a shirt blouse must be worn with a jacket if it is short sleeve, or they should exercise good taste and judgement in dressing for the job. At all times, a professional image should be maintained.

GUIDELINES

Black or dark blue jeans/skirts must be worn. Shirts must be tucked in, if there are loops on the pants/skirt a **plain** belt must be worn (gold, silver or other decorative belts are not allowed).

The following are not allowed: -

- White-washed, two toned or tri-coloured black jeans/skirts, cut-out spandex, or oversized legged pants.
- “Skinny jeans”
- Bell bottom or hipsters pants.
- Tight fitting pants/skirt.
- T-shirts/Polo shirts
- Patches, tears, holes or decorative markings on the pants/skirt.
- Shorts or miniskirts.
- Slippers, sandals, track shoes/sneakers.
- Headwear (except for religious purposes).

PLEASE REMEMBER THAT ALTHOUGH THE DRESS CODE IS MORE RELAXED ON “DRESS DOWN DAYS” STAFF MEMBERS ARE STILL EXPECTED TO ADHERE TO THE DEPARTMENT’S DRESS CODE AND TO BE PROFESSIONALLY ATTIRED.

Areas Outlined: -

1. DAY-TO-DAY
2. EXHIBITION
3. TRAINING

1. DAY-TO-DAY

All members of staff employed to the Ministry of National Security/Police Department should at all times be properly attired and well groomed when reporting for duty each day. Members of staff who are in receipt of uniform allowance are required to be appropriately in their uniform.

The following should be adhered to: -

A. CLOTHING

Skirts and Dress

- Excessively tight clothing must not be worn.
- Can be any solid colour or moderate print.
- Hemlines must not exceed **one inch** above the knees. Split in skirts should not exceed **four inches** above the knees.
- Hemlines lower than **four inches** above the knee (maxi skirts) are not permitted.
- Petticoats (undergarment worn under a skirt, e.g. slip) must not be revealed where there is a split.

Fabric

- Dress fabric with an outstanding sheen and transparent (see through materials) are not permitted. Colour must be suitable and conform to a business appearance.
- Avoid lingerie looks or overly revealing outfits.

Pants – Female

A tailored pant is preferable at the ankle length. Jackets are not mandatory.

- Shorts should not be worn whilst on duty.
- Shredded garments should not be worn.
- Culottes (a form of split skirt) should not be worn.

- Knickers, gauche pants, palazzo pants, corduroy, and dungarees (heavy denim pants or overalls) are not permitted.
- Only black or dark blue jeans pants/skirts (no pattern) may be worn on the last Fridays of each month with a shirt blouse. If the shirt blouse has a short sleeve, a jacket must be worn.

Pants and Shirts – Male

- Pants must be suitable for corporate office.
- Colour must be conservative.
- Belts must be worn with all pants designed with belt loops.
- Bush jackets and cerebra suits are only suitable alternative to pants, shirt and tie.
- Jeans, except for “Dress Down Fridays”, corduroy, dungaree, patchwork pants are not permitted.
- Top buttons of shirts must be buttoned under the ties.
- T-shirt worn under shirt must not be seen. Outside shirts must be buttoned to the second button from top if a tie is not being worn.
- Shirts must always be properly tucked inside the pants except for shirt jackets (Bush Jackets).
- Shirts should be buttoned to cover the chest.
- T-shirts and Polo shirts are not permitted.
- Undershirts or shirts meant to be worn as undergarments are inappropriate.
- Flashy “loud” clothing (including undershirts with printed messages) is inappropriate.

Blouses and Shirts - Females

- Any solid colour or moderate print cut on tailored lines.

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- No plunging necklines.
- Sleeveless blouses should not reveal underarm, they must not be worn alone. A blazer/jacket must accompany same.
- T-shirts and polo shirts are not permitted.

B. FOOTWEAR

- Shoes should be comfortable, enhancing the dress.
- Appropriate footwear must be worn at all times.
- Slippers or flat sandals may be worn to the office with permission of the immediate supervisor or The Human Resource Branch and must be related to a medical condition.
- Sneakers may only be worn when going on field assignments.
- Persons issued with safety boots are required to wear them while on the job.
- Clogs, earth shoes, joggers, beach sandals, mules, ballets and flat sandals are unacceptable footwear.

C. HAIR GROOMING

Women:

- Hair styles must be neat, attractively becoming to the individual and suitable for the job. The style chosen must be maintained at all times.
- Outrageous bright coloured (natural/false) hair will not be allowed; extensions should match as close as possible with natural hair.
- Excessively long braids must be pinned or neatly styled.
- Only appropriate wigs should be worn.
- Extreme, un-business like styles, elastic, rubber bands and string are unacceptable.

- Braiding is acceptable but discretion must be used.
- Eyebrows must not have any creative design.

Men:

- Hair must be neatly cut.
- Eyebrows must not have any creative design.
- Must have hair appropriately groomed.

D. JEWELLRY

Women:

- Elaborate jewellery should be avoided. (They present an unprofessional appearance and are quite distracting).
- No more than one pair of earring should be worn at any one time.
- Earrings should not be worn in the upper ear.
- One or a maximum of two simple strands of gold or silver chain with the appropriate pendant may be worn.
- No more than two rings on the same hand, medium sized or in good taste.
- **Engagement and wedding rings worn together will be counted as one.**
- Nose or tongue rings should not be worn.
- Body piercing and tattoos should not be visible.
- One wrist watch is appropriate.

Men:

- No earrings must be worn whilst on official duty.
- Body piercing and tattoos should not be visible.
- One wrist watch is appropriate.

E. FINGER NAILS

- Excessively long and patterned fingernails are not allowed. French tips are allowed.
- Nails should be well manicured.

F. HOSIERY IS NOT MANDATORY

G. PERSONAL HYGIENE

- Clean, fresh clothes must be worn at all times.
- Wrinkled, stained or dirty clothing is inappropriate groomed appearance at all times.

H. CAPS

- May only be worn on field assignments or outdoor assignments on premises.

I. CONDUCT

- Each employee has a responsibility to the JCF, our clients and other members of the public, to project a positive image of the department.
- Tact and diplomacy must be exercised at all times. Employees must be courteous and business like with others, even under difficult conditions and in times of personal stress that may or may not involve any violation of the law.

2. EXHIBITIONS

Members of staff going on exhibition must adhere to rule number one (1); however, the following may be allowed if the exhibition is outdoors: -

Clothing

- Only black or dark blue jeans pants/skirts (non-patterned) may be worn along with an appropriate shirt.

3. TRAINING

Members of staff going on training must adhere to rule number one (1).

SANCTIONS/DISCIPLINARY ACTION

Failure to comply with the uniform requirement while on duty and failure to maintain clean, neat and business-like appearance will lead to the following: -

1. First offence
 - Oral admonition/warning to appropriate administration action.
Person must be sent home to change their clothing, and they must report back to work before 11:00 am.
If they are unable to report at that time, then one day is deducted from their departmental/vacation leave entitlement.
2. Second Offence
 - Monetary fine to written admonition (Public Services Regulation, 1961, Section 37.2 “where a fine is imposed the amount of such fine shall be deducted from the salary or the officer by such instalments as may be specified at the time the penalty is imposed”).
3. Third Offence
 - Subject to disciplinary action (Public Services Regulation, 1961, Section 37.1 a, b, c) “the penalties which may be imposed on an officer against whom a disciplinary charge has been established are: -“
 - a. Dismissal
 - b. Reduction in Rank
 - c. Deferment or withholding of increment
(Public Service Regulations, 1961, Section 37.2, “where a fine is imposed the amount of such fine shall be deducted from the salary of the officer by such instalments as may be specified at the time the penalty is imposed.”)

The sanction for temporary employees disobeying the dress code is dismissal. (Section, 19a, b, c of the Public Service Regulations.)

- a. “The appropriate authorized officer may after such informal enquiry as he may think fit, forthwith dismiss a temporary employee if he is satisfied that such employee has been guilty of any misconduct”

- b. “The appropriate authorized officer may, without any enquiry being held or without giving him two weeks’ notice (or such other notice as may be specified in his letter of appointment) or two weeks’ salary in lieu of notice”
- c. “Every daily paid or casual employee may be dismissed by the appropriate authorised officer without any enquiry being held and without reasons or notice being given.”

Please be guided accordingly and ensure that the regulations are enforced.